6.2.3 Hair Care

The condition of the hair reflects to some extent the nutritional status and general health of the body. Thin, sparse hair and the loss of hair indicates a poor nutritional status. The deficiencies in diet, physical and mental illness of various kinds may also lead to premature greying of hair.

The hair follicles from which the hair grows produce oil which keeps the hair smooth. The sweat and the dead skin cells come off the scalp. The oil, sweat and dead cells all add together and can make the hair greasy and look dirty unless it is washed regularly.

Keeping hair clean and healthy

- Regular hair wash and massage of the scalp will remove the dead skin cells, excess oil and dust.
- Rinsing the hair well with clear water and using good toothed comb for hair dressing is highly essential for the maintenance of hair.

6.3 Diseases

A disease is the functional or physical change from a normal state that affects the health of a person by causing disability or discomfort. The following are the conditions that could lead to the development of disease in an individual.

- Infection caused by disease-causing microbes.
- Lack of balanced diet.
- Poor lifestyle and unhealthy habits.
- Malfunctioning of one or more body parts or organs.

The prevention and treatment of diseases can be considered in two groups for their better understanding. They are communicable and non-communicable disease.

6.3.1 Communicable Diseases

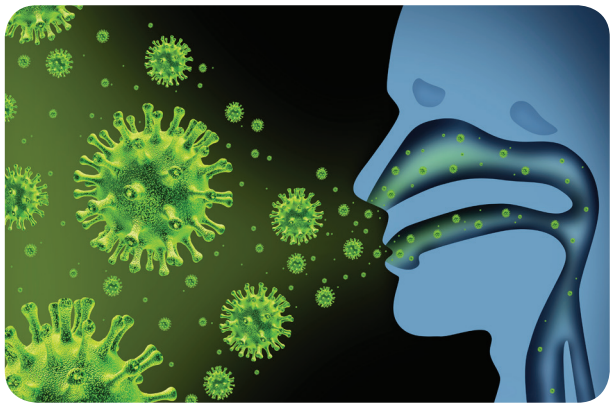
Communicable diseases are those diseases that spread from one person to another. Healthy persons must be protected from people with communicable diseases. Diseases spread through contaminated air, water, food or vectors (insects and other animals).

a. Diseases caused by Bacteria

Communicable diseases like tuberculosis, cholera and typhoid, are caused by bacteria. These diseases spread through air, water and some other organisms.

1. Tuberculosis

Tuberculosis (TB) is caused by ***Mycobacterium tuberculae*** and spreads from one person to another person through air, spitting, prolonged contact and sharing materials of the patient. The symptoms are fever, weight loss, chronic cough, bloody spitting and difficulty in breathing.



Mycobacterium tuberculae

Prevention and treatment

- BCG vaccination.
- Giving special attention to the patient.
- Regular medication like DOT.